

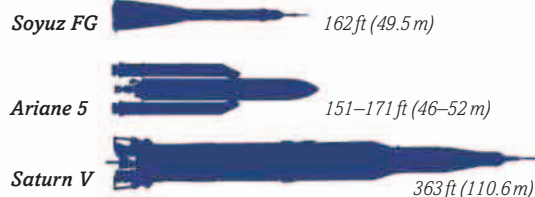
Launch vehicles



Saturn V's five rocket engines burned **3,358 gal** (12,710 liters) of fuel per second.

Shuttle's three rocket engines propel it to speeds of more than 16,777 mph (27,000 km/h)

LENGTH Short to long



Enormous power is needed to overcome gravity and travel into space—so satellites and spacecraft are propelled by launch vehicles, with rocket engines and their own fuel supply. While rockets can only be used once, space shuttles are reusable.

To carry heavy cargos into space multistage launch vehicles are used, such as the two-stage **Long March 2F**, which carried the Shenzhou spacecraft in 2003, and the **Ariane 5s**, which have made more than 75 successful launches. Each stage of a launch vehicle has its own

